

The Emperor of Ice-Cream

By [Wallace Stevens](#)

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Call the roller of big cigars,
The muscular one, and **bid** him whip
In kitchen cups **concupiscent** curds.
Let the **wenches** dawdle in such dress
As they are used to wear, and let the boys
Bring flowers in last month's newspapers.
Let be be finale of seem.
The only emperor is the emperor of ice-cream.

Take from the dresser of **deal**,
Lacking the three glass knobs, that sheet
On which she embroidered **fantails** once
And spread it so as to cover her face.
If her horny feet protrude, they come
To show how cold she is, and dumb.
Let the lamp affix its beam.
The only emperor is the emperor of ice-cream.